



info.nodes

We believe in an open and free society where corruption, abuses and inequalities are fought back by a proactive citizenship

VISION AND MISSION

We believe in an open and free society, where corruption, abuses and inequalities are fought back by a proactive civil society.

Our mission is to contrast corruption, social injustice and inequalities by the empowerment and networking of local communities composed by activists, journalists and civic technologists.

WHY info.nodes?

While criminal organisations, corrupted officials and dodgy business are increasing their power and wealth in Europe and around the World, the space for the civil society is clearly shrinking and suffering for a lack of resources and capacities.

The recent report "Freedom of the World 2019" by Freedom House shows the continuous decline in global freedom, highlighting how *"Freedom of expression has come under sustained attack, through both assaults on the press and encroachments on the speech rights of ordinary citizens"*.

The Secretary General of the Council of Europe also decided to point out in his annual report (2018) *"the adverse impact of unduly restrictive laws and practices on the freedom of association and freedom of assembly and, ultimately, on democracy itself"*.

It is not just a matter of "intimidation": activists and investigative journalists are in serious danger, as the killing of Daphne Caruana Galizia in Malta and of Ján Kuciak in Slovakia few months later demonstrate.

The brutal assassination of two brave journalists in the heart of the civilized Europe, unequivocally means that something more must be done for protecting and empowering the investigative journalism and the activists.

Violence is not the only means used by organised crime or authoritarian regimes for putting civil society in the corner. The cut of economic resources and opportunities of funding, as happened in Hungary and Poland, is a major threat for activists. Then, the "anti-NGOs storytelling" emphasized -

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if not coordinated - by governments and media had a negative impact on civil society, withdrawing people from non-governmental organisations.

However protection is not enough, info.nodes also supports and encourages journalists and activists in doing their fundamental job: **expose the truth and promote effective social changes**.

The ambition of info.nodes is to improve the ways journalists, activists and civic technologists collaborate and support each other.

There are many projects and activities in Europe and globally where these three categories collaborate, but only in few cases the collaboration starts from the very beginning, with a shared and uniform vision and objective.

For these reasons info.nodes aims at engaging local communities of journalists, activists and civic technologists, providing them with capacities, competences and skills, enabling them to design and conduct analysis and investigations aiming at a shared social change.

OUR GOALS AND HOW TO ACHIEVE THEM

info.nodes has two main goals.

1. To create, empower and strengthen citizens, local communities and groups in order to promote social changes.

In order to achieve this goal, info.nodes aims to create a network of investigative and data journalists, civic technologists, activists and creative people. These actors can work and collaborate in groups or communities (the “**nodes**”).

The nodes need high competences and interdisciplinary skills, so the first step is to provide such know-how to the node-members, through specific workshops with experts in different fields.

The journalists member of a node should be able to investigate and publish cases and stories; the civic technologists should be able to help them to find, analyse and visualize the information collected; the activists should be able to trigger social change (e.g. policy impact, judiciary process, regulatory improvements) by running local public campaign or joining larger campaigns, also using data and information collected and analysed by journalists and civic technologists.

2. To promote a more open and transparent society, through the exposition of cases and the campaigning for changes.

In order to achieve this goal info.nodes aims to carry on researches and investigations; to expose cases and stories; to raise awareness on issues related to corruption, social justice, climate justice, inequalities; to campaign and advocate for change.

Furthermore, info.nodes will join international and global campaigns and networks, offering its skills and competences for analysing and exposing cases and for disseminating the campaigns nationally and locally.



MAIN ACTIVITIES

- **Expose the truth**

info.nodes runs investigations and exposes cases with selected media partners.

See for example:

<https://www.occrp.org/en/investigations/murder-drugs-and-extortion-in-tuscanys-chinese-underworld>

- **Promote social changes**

info.nodes takes part in global campaigns, acting as catalyst for the local groups of activists.

See for example:

<https://reclaimyourface.eu/>

- **Raise awareness**

Info.nodes communicates through its social channels, participates to public events and publishes MARLA, the magazine on corruption, injustice and inequalities that use an uncommon “language” mixing serious contents, arts and pop visuals.

See here the past editions of MARLA:

<https://infonodes.org/marla>

- **Capacity Building**

info.nodes participates and organises workshops and laboratories for local communities, journalists and activists.

See for example:

<https://www.cittadinireattivi.it/2021/03/26/stiamo-per-stupirvi/>

FOUNDER MEMBERS

Davide Del Monte (President), activist

Davide Del Monte joined the Italian Chapter of Transparency International in 2008 and in 2015 was nominated Executive Director of the organisation. In April 2018 he was nominated president of the commission for the protection of whistleblowers in the Municipality of Milano.

His main areas of expertise are corruption, state capture, social justice and surveillance.

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Guido Romeo, data journalist

Guido Romeo, journalist and author, deals with systems of innovation, digital economy, journalism and information transparency.

He chairs Facta, a non-profit center applying scientific methods to journalism.

He has received awards in Italy and abroad and carries out research and surveys of data journalism and writes for Il Sole 24 Ore for which he has co-edited the contents of two editions of Open Innovation Days.

He is the author of Silenzi di Stato, storie di trasparenza negata e di cittadini che non si arrendono (Chiarelettere 2016). He is a lecturer in data journalism, digital journalism and access to information at the IULM University, at the Sole24Ore Business School, at SISSA - International Advanced School of Advanced Studies in Trieste, and in courses recognized by the Italian Journalists Association.

He was economy and data editor for Wired Italy, participating in the organization of two editions of the Wired Next Fest.

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Fabio Pietrosanti, civic technologist

Fabio Pietrosanti is the President and co-founder of the Hermes Center for Transparency and Digital Human Rights.

He is active in many projects to create and spread the use of digital tools in support of freedom of expression and transparency and he is among the founders of the anonymous whistleblowing GlobaLeaks project, nowadays used by investigative journalists, citizen activists and the public administration for anti-corruption purposes.

Fabio has been part of the hacking digital underground with the nickname "naif" since 1995, while he's been a professional working in digital security since 1998

He is an expert in technological innovation in the field of whistleblowing, transparency, communication encryption and digital anonymity.

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Giuseppe Imbrogno, expert of non-profit organisations

Has more than 15 years of experience in the non profit sector, at first as development and fundraising consultant and in the last 10 years as senior programme manager in welfare and social policies (ACLI Lombardia).

His main areas of interest and expertise are: social planning, project management and budgeting; impact assessment and evaluation; social and educational policies; national and EU funding, public-private financing.

Has been integrating the designing and management work with some writing activity: scientific articles, short stories, a prized novel.

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Chiara Putaturo, activist

Chiara Putaturo is policy advisor on inequality and tax for the EU office of Oxfam International. Her main activity is advocacy at EU level for ending corporate tax avoidance and increasing countries' domestic resource mobilisation for funding public services and reducing inequalities.

Until January 2019 she was project officer for the Italian chapter of Transparency International, where she worked for 8 years on citizens' and students' engagement and on anti corruption and transparency in public institutions.

Her main skills are project management, reporting, people engagement, institutional advocacy.

Her main areas of expertise are corruption, lobbying, transparency, economic inequalities and corporate tax avoidance.

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Gloria Riva, investigative journalist

Gloria Riva is an investigative journalist at l'Espresso from 2014 and an Italian member of the International Consortium of Investigative Journalism, Icij. She is part of the Pulitzer Prize-winning team of journalists that broke the story on Panama Papers in 2016.

She covered many international stories about tax evasion, fiscal heaven, financial scandal, as Lux Leaks, Swiss Leaks (well known as Lagarde's List), Paradise Papers, Bahamas Leaks, Panama Papers 2, Implant Files and more.

Her main areas of investigations are economics, political economy, public economy, public health system

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Stefano Vergine, investigative journalist

Stefano Vergine served as reporter and deputy news editor of the Italian weekly L'Espresso from 2014 to 2018, after having worked as Australia correspondent for RSI (Swiss public radio in Italian) from 2012 to 2014.

Over the last years he contributed to the Panama Papers, Malta Files and Football Leaks investigations. He's also co-author of Il Libro Nero della Lega, where the plan to channel Russian oil funds to Matteo Salvini party was first revealed.

His main areas of investigation are economics, finance and politics

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